

Part 4

In this part, we are going to discuss about the activity areas and relevant objects.

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Activity Areas

Logical area of the warehouse, which groups storage bins together with regards to specific warehouse activities.

Examples of activity areas:

- Putaway
- Picking
- Physical inventory

They do **not** depend on physical layout — instead, they group bins by *operational purpose* so that tasks can be created, sorted, and executed efficiently.

Why Activity Areas Are Used?

Activity Areas enable you to:

- **Group storage bins** for specific activities (e.g., picking area vs. putaway area).
- **Optimize task creation** — Generate warehouse tasks only for bins belonging to the appropriate area.

- **Sort and sequence tasks** (e.g., for efficient picking routes).
- **Support multiple processes** on the same physical storage bins.

Activities

Activities represent the *specific warehouse operations* performed during the movement, handling, and management of stock. They are used in configuration to control processes like picking, putaway, replenishment, physical inventory, etc.

An activity in a warehouse that triggers goods movements.

Examples of activities:

- Perform physical inventory
- Perform picking
- Perform replenishment
- Perform putaway

An activity must be uniquely assigned to a warehouse process category.

Define Warehouse process category

Warehouse Process Category classifies and groups warehouse processes at the highest level. It defines *what type of warehouse operation* is being executed and determines the available configuration options for Warehouse Process Types, Activities, and Task creation. It is one of the core elements used to control end-to-end execution of warehouse movements.

Purpose of Warehouse Process Category

Warehouse Process Categories help the system understand:

- **Which business process** is being executed (e.g., inbound vs. outbound)
- **Which activities** are involved (pick, putaway, replenishment, etc.)
- **What kind of warehouse tasks** must be created
- **Whether stock is being placed into storage or removed**
- **Which actions and rules apply** (HU handling, staging, internal moves, etc.)

Each **Warehouse Process Type** is always assigned to exactly **one** Warehouse Process Category.

To Create / Display / Change, go to SCON Configuration → Warehouse Structure – Activity areas – Activities – Define warehouse process category.

Field name	Data type	Length	Domain
Warehouse number	CHAR	4	Text
Warehouse process category	CHAR	1	Text
Description	CHAR	40	Text

Sample data:

Warehouse number	Warehouse process category	Description
1000	1	Putaway
1000	2	Stock Removal
1000	3	Internal Warehouse Movement
1000	4	Physical Inventory
1000	5	Posting Change

Define Activities for Activity Areas and assign the warehouse process category

To Create / Display / Change, go to SCON Configuration → Warehouse Structure – Activity areas – Activities – Define Activities for Activity Areas and assign the warehouse process category.

Field name	Data type	Length	Domain
Warehouse number	CHAR	4	Text
Activity	CHAR	4	Text
Description	CHAR	40	Text
Warehouse process category	CHAR	1	Drop down

Sample data:

Warehouse number	Activity	Description	Warehouse process category
1000	PTWY	Putaway	1
1000	PICK	Stock removal	2
1000	REPL	Replenishment	3
1000	INTL	Internal movements	3
1000	INVE	Physical Inventory	4
1000	POST	Posting change	5

Define Activity Areas

To Create / Display / Change, go to SCON Configuration → Warehouse Structure – Activity areas – Define Activity Areas

Field name	Data type	Length	Domain
Warehouse number	CHAR	4	Text
Activity area	CHAR	4	Text
Description	CHAR	40	Text

Sample data:

Warehouse number	Activity Area	Description
1000	PA01	GR00 to PF00 Putaway
1000	PA02	ID00 to PB00 (PA - Side1)
1000	PA03	ID00 to PB00 (PA - Side2)
1000	PA04	GR00 to ID00 Internal
1000	PA05	GR00 to DY00 Putaway
1000	PA06	GR00 to MZ00 Putaway
1000	PI01	PI Area for ground level items
1000	PI02	PI Area for higher level items
1000	RE01	Replenishment Area 01
1000	RE02	Replenishment Area 02
1000	RE03	Replenishment Area 03
1000	RE04	Replenishment Area 04 (Mezzanine)

1000	RE06	Replenishment Activity Area MZ00
1000	SCRP	Activity Area for Storage Type SCRP
1000	SR01	CD00, PF00, MZ00, DY00 to GI00 (Stk Rmvl)
1000	SR03	PB00 to GI00 (Bulk picking)

Assign Storage Bins to Activity Areas

To Create / Display / Change, go to SCON Configuration → Warehouse Structure – Activity areas – Assign storage bins to activity areas.

In this Customizing activity, you can assign storage bins to activity areas. You can assign storage bins explicitly or implicitly.

You have defined storage bin identifiers for the storage bin structures. For more information, see Define Storage Bin Identifiers for Storage Bin Structures.

You have defined storage bins for the warehouse structure or have manually entered the storage bin identifiers in the database. For more information, see Define Storage Bin Structure and Edit Storage Bin.

Assign the storage bins to activity areas using one of the following options:

Explicitly enter all parts of the storage bins.

To do this, enter the intervals for your individual storage bin parts (such as Aisle Start or Aisle End). Make these entries for all storage bin parts in the relevant storage bins, including the storage bin subdivisions. You have defined the storage bins in the storage bin structure. The system only assigns the relevant storage bins to the activity area if they are completely specified.

If you want to define your storage bins as a consolidation group, make an entry in the Cons.Grp field. For more information, see Cons.Grp.

Implicitly enter the storage type.

Enter only the storage type. You can leave all the remaining fields empty. The system specifies the storage bins using the storage type, and assigns all storage bins within this storage type to the activity area.

Field name	Data type	Length	Domain
Warehouse number	CHAR	4	Text
Activity area	CHAR	4	Drop Down
Sequence number	CHAR	5	Numeric
Storage Type	CHAR	4	Drop Down
Aisle Start	CHAR	18	Text
Aisle End	CHAR	18	Text
Stack Start	CHAR	18	Text
Stack End	CHAR	18	Text
Level Start	CHAR	18	Text
Level End	CHAR	18	Text
Bin Section Start	CHAR	18	Text
Bin Section End	CHAR	18	Text

Define Sort Sequence

Sort Sequence for Stack, Level, and Bin Item

You use this field to define the sort sequence of storage bins in each activity area. The sorting is done using the following values of a storage bin:

- Aisle
- Stack
- Level
- Bin subdivision
- Bin depth

You cannot influence the aisle and the bin depth using a sort sequence. The aisle is always the field that changes the least frequently whereas the bin depth changes the most frequently. You can influence the sorting of the other fields, such as the Stack field, by using a sort sequence.

Example

Earlier you have defined a storage bin structure A-S-L-B, under Define Storage Bin Structure, where A represents the aisle ID, S is stack, L is level, and B is a bin subdivision. Each field uses the values 1 to 4.

Note

As bin depth changes with each row, it is omitted from the example.

The bins look as follows:

1-1-1-1
1-1-1-2
1-1-1-3
1-1-1-4
1-1-2-1
1-1-2-2
1-1-2-3
1-1-2-4
1-1-3-1
1-1-3-2
1-1-3-3
1-1-3-4
1-1-4-1
1-1-4-2
1-1-4-3
1-1-4-4
1-2-1-1
...
4-4-3-4
4-4-4-1
4-4-4-2
4-4-4-3
4-4-4-4

The examples below use different sort sequences but leave other settings with the default value, for example No Alternation and No Specific Division by Stack.
For each example, you have defined a sort sequence under Define Sort Sequence for Activity Area.

Sort sequence: 1 Sort Sequence: Stack, Level, Bin Subdivision

1-1-1-1
1-2-1-1
1-3-1-1
1-4-1-1
1-1-2-1
1-2-2-1
1-3-2-1
1-4-2-1
1-1-3-1
1-2-3-1
1-3-3-1
1-4-3-1
1-1-4-1
1-2-4-1
1-3-4-1
1-4-4-1
1-1-1-2
...
4-4-3-4
4-1-4-4
4-2-4-4
4-3-4-4
4-4-4-4

Sort sequence: 2 Sort Sequence: Stack, Bin Subdivision, Level

1-1-1-1
1-2-1-1
1-3-1-1
1-4-1-1
1-1-1-2
1-2-1-2
1-3-1-2
1-4-1-2
1-1-1-3
1-2-1-3
1-3-1-3
1-4-1-3
1-1-1-4
1-2-1-4
1-3-1-4
1-4-1-4
1-1-2-1
...
4-4-4-3

4-1-4-4
4-2-4-4
4-3-4-4
4-4-4-4

Sort sequence: 3 Sort Sequence: Level, Stack, Bin Subdivision

1-1-1-1
1-1-2-1
1-1-3-1
1-1-4-1
1-2-1-1
1-2-2-1
1-2-3-1
1-2-4-1
1-3-1-1
1-3-2-1
1-3-3-1
1-3-4-1
1-4-1-1
1-4-2-1
1-4-3-1
1-4-4-1
1-1-1-2
...
4-3-4-4
4-4-1-4
4-4-2-4
4-4-3-4
4-4-4-4

Sort sequence: 4 Sort Sequence: Level, Bin Subdivision, Stack

1-1-1-1
1-1-2-1
1-1-3-1
1-1-4-1
1-1-1-2
1-1-2-2
1-1-3-2
1-1-4-2
1-1-1-3
1-1-2-3
1-1-3-3
1-1-4-3
1-1-1-4
1-1-2-4
1-1-3-4
1-1-4-4
1-2-1-1
...
4-4-4-3

4-4-1-4
4-4-2-4
4-4-3-4
4-4-4-4

Sort sequence: 5 Sort Sequence: Bin Subdivision, Level, Stack

1-1-1-1
1-1-1-2
1-1-1-3
1-1-1-4
1-1-2-1
1-1-2-2
1-1-2-3
1-1-2-4
1-1-3-1
1-1-3-2
1-1-3-3
1-1-3-4
1-1-4-1
1-1-4-2
1-1-4-3
1-1-4-4
1-2-1-1
...
4-4-3-4
4-4-4-1
4-4-4-2
4-4-4-3
4-4-4-4

Sort sequence: 6 Sort Sequence: Bin Subdivision, Stack, Level

1-1-1-1
1-1-1-2
1-1-1-3
1-1-1-4
1-2-1-1
1-2-1-2
1-2-1-3
1-2-1-4
1-3-1-1
1-3-1-2
1-3-1-3
1-3-1-4
1-4-1-1
1-4-1-2
1-4-1-3
1-4-1-4
1-1-2-1
...
4-3-4-4

4-4-4-1
4-4-4-2
4-4-4-3
4-4-4-4

To Create / Display / Change, go to SCON Configuration → Warehouse Structure – Activity areas – Define Sort Sequence.

Field name	Data type	Length	Domain
Warehouse number	CHAR	4	Text
Sort Sequence	CHAR	1	Text
Description	CHAR	40	Text

Sample data

Warehouse number	Sort Sequence	Description
1000	1	Stack - Level - Bin Subdivision
1000	2	Stack - Bin Subdivision - Level
1000	3	Level - Stack - Bin Subdivision
1000	4	Level - Bin Subdivision - Stack
1000	5	Bin Subdivision - Level- Stack
1000	6	Bin Subdivision - Stack - Level

Assign Sort Sequence to Activity Areas (In SAP, it is called as Define Sort Sequence for Activity Areas)

A **Sort Sequence for Activity Areas** is a key element that determines **the order in which warehouse tasks (WTs)** are processed within an **Activity Area**—typically for **picking, putaway, replenishment, or physical inventory**.

It is one of the core tools to **optimize travel paths, create efficient warehouse orders, and ensure the correct bin processing order**.

What Is a Sort Sequence?

A **Sort Sequence** defines *how storage bins in an Activity Area should be sorted* during:

- Picking
- Putaway
- Replenishment
- Inventory counting

The sorting logic allows EWM to create Warehouse Orders that follow the most efficient route or required operational sequence.

Why Sort Sequences Are Needed?

Sort sequences determine:

- The **direction** a picker moves through aisles
- The **path** for putaway

- The **bin order** for cycle counting
- Optimization for RF-driven operations
- Grouping WTs into Warehouse Orders following warehouse layout

Without sort sequence:

- Bins appear in **random order**
- Travel time increases
- Picking routes become inefficient

SAP Reference:

Change View "Define Sort Sequence of Storage Bins for Ac..": Details

New Entries

Warehouse No. NDC Warehouse

Activity Area GR00 to PF00 Putaway

Activity Putaway

Sequence No.

ibmasalaiman@healthirl.net
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Define Sort Sequence of Storage Bins for Activity Areas

Storage Type

Sort Sequence

Sort.Dir.: Aisle

Sort Dir. f. Stack

Path Dir.: Stack

Sort Dir. Level

Path Dir.: Level

Sort Dir. Bin Subd.

Path Dir.: Bin Subd.

Picking Mode

Fixed Sorting ☐

To Create / Display / Change, go to SCON Configuration → Warehouse Structure – Activity areas – Assign Sort Sequence to Activity Areas.

Field name	Data type	Length	Domain
Warehouse number	CHAR	4	Text
Activity area	CHAR	4	Drop Down
Activity	CHAR	4	Drop Down
Sequence number	CHAR	5	Numeric
Sort Sequence	CHAR	1	Drop Down
Sorting Direction for Aisle	CHAR	1	Drop Down 1. Ascending 2. Descending

Sort Direction for Stack	CHAR	1	Drop Down 1. Ascending 2. Descending
Path Direction: Stack	CHAR	1	Drop Down 1. Alternating 2. Not Alternating
Sort Direction Level	CHAR	1	Drop Down 1. Ascending 2. Descending
Path Direction: Level	CHAR	1	Drop Down 1. Alternating 2. Not Alternating
Sort Direction: Bin Subdivision	CHAR	1	Drop Down 1. Ascending 2. Descending
Path Direction: Bin Subdivision	CHAR	1	Drop Down 1. Alternating 2. Not Alternating
Picking Mode	CHAR	1	Drop Down 1. Only Odd 2. Only Even 3. Both sides 4. First odd, then even 5. First even, then odd 6. No specific direction by stack